LTL Single Shipment Quote SOP

Owner: Jericho Freight	**Effective Date: 08/25/26**
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General Information

Description / Objective	Teach any Jericho teammate, even someone brand new, how to build one Less-Than-Truckload quote for one shipment, how the app does the math, what every printed field means, and why that field helps the customer say yes.
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Glossary

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1. Our company and this quote type

1.1 What LTL means in basic words

Imagine a giant box truck. If you only have a few boxes, you do not need to rent the whole truck. You share the truck with other people's boxes. That shared ride is called LTL, which stands for Less Than Truckload.

A pallet is a wooden square that boxes sit on, like a little raft for cargo. The customer pays mostly by how many pallets they send, plus extra fees if the delivery is hard (like a house with no dock).

This SOP is only for the Single Shipment builder. That builder answers one question: 'What does it cost to move this many pallets, on this lane, this one time?'

1.2 When to use Single Shipment instead of Tiered

Use Single Shipment when the customer already knows the pallet count. Example: 'I have 6 pallets going from Medley to Pensacola next Tuesday.'

Use the Tiered builder when the customer wants a price menu for different sizes, like 1 pallet vs 6 pallets vs 14 pallets, so they can see that bigger shipments get a cheaper price per pallet.

If you pick the wrong one, the quote will still print, but it will not match the conversation. Always match the tool to the question the customer asked.

- Single Shipment = one count, one all-in total, one printed ledger.
- Tiered = four price tiers plus savings and charts.
- Both print with the file name LTL-Q plus the quote number.
- Their Load Previous Quote lists are separate. A tiered quote will not fill this form.

2. How to open the builder

2.1 Click path

On the home screen, hover over the LTL button. A small menu pops up. Click Single Shipment Quote. The title at the top should say LTL Single Shipment Quote.

If you landed on the tiered builder by accident, use the link that says Open Single Shipment Quote.

Your name and email must already be saved under Change User. If they are not, the app sends you to that screen first. Those two fields print on every quote so the customer knows who to contact.

3. Customer name on the quote

3.1 Include customer on quote

Near the top is a checkbox: Include customer on quote. If it is off, the printed page does not show a customer name. That is fine for a blind estimate.

If it is on, two boxes appear: Customer name and Contact email. Start typing a name. The app looks in your local customer list and can fill the email for you.

When you generate with the box on, the app also remembers that name on this computer so next time you can pick it faster. This list is yours only.

4. Load a previous LTL single quote

4.1 The header picker

Top right you will see Load Previous Quote. This list only shows quotes you already generated in this Single Shipment builder on this computer.

Click Select a quote, then click a label like LTL-Q12. The form fills itself: cities, ZIPs, pallets, money, checkboxes, and miles if you had them.

It will not pull FTL, Dray, International, or LTL Tiered quotes. Those live in other lists on purpose so the wrong boxes do not get filled.

5. Route / lane fields

5.1 Origin and destination

Origin City and Origin ZIP Code are where the freight starts, like a warehouse door. Destination City and Destination ZIP Code are where it ends.

ZIP codes are the most important. The app uses them to measure road miles. City names print so the customer recognizes the lane.

Click Calculate Distance after both ZIPs are filled. The app asks Google for a truck-friendly drive. The miles land in a hidden box called manual_miles. Generate does not call Google again. It uses the miles you already have.

If Google is not set up, type the miles you trust, or leave miles blank. Some analytics on the output need miles. The dollar total still works without miles.

6. Cargo profile fields

6.1 Counts, weight, and size

Number of Pallets is how many wooden rafts are on this shipment. It must be at least 1.

Total Cargo Weight (lbs) is how heavy everything is together, not per pallet.

Commodity Value / Pallet ($) is how much one pallet of goods is worth. This is not the freight price. It is used later to estimate how expensive it is to have goods sitting on a truck for extra days (pipeline inventory).

Pallet Length, Width, and Height are in inches. A normal grocery pallet is about 48 by 40, but this form defaults near 48 x 48 x 48 so you can change it. Size is used to guess density, which is how heavy the freight is for the space it takes. Carriers use density to pick an NMFC class, which can change the real invoice later if the freight is fluffier or denser than you said.

Density math (pounds per cubic foot)

Cubic feet for one pallet = (length x width x height) / 1728. The number 1728 is how many cubic inches fit in one cubic foot, because 12 x 12 x 12 = 1728.

Total cubic feet = cubic feet for one pallet x pallet count.

Density = total weight / total cubic feet.

Tiny example: 6 pallets, 48 x 48 x 48 in, 3000 lb. One pallet is 64 cubic feet. Six pallets are 384 cubic feet. Density is 3000 / 384 = about 7.81 lb per cubic foot. That density maps to an NMFC class in the app's table (around class 100 in this case).

7. All-in pricing ledger and the math

7.1 The three money boxes

Linehaul Base Fee is the truck's main ride price, like the taxi fare before extras.

Fuel Surcharge / FSC is extra money because diesel costs money. You type a dollar amount here on this form, not a percent.

Quoted Rate / Pallet is a helper. If you type a per-pallet rate and linehaul is empty, the app splits that rate into about 82% linehaul and 18% fuel so the ledger still has two lines. If you already typed linehaul, the printed per-pallet rate is the all-in total divided by pallets, not this helper box.

The live summary on the form adds linehaul + fuel + checked accessorials while you type so you can see the total before you generate.

All-in total for this shipment

total = linehaul + fuel surcharge + accessorial fees

price per pallet on the printout = total / pallet count

Tiny example: linehaul $984, fuel $216, liftgate $75. Total = $1,275. For 6 pallets, price per pallet = $1,275 / 6 = $212.50.

If you only typed $200 per pallet for 6 pallets and left linehaul at 0, the app estimates total $1,200, then linehaul $984 (82%) and fuel $216 (18%).

8. Accessorial checkboxes

8.1 Extra work, extra money

An accessorial is extra work the truck must do. Think of it as paying for a special request, not the main ride.

Liftgate default $75. A liftgate is a metal shelf on the back of the truck that goes up and down, used when the building has no dock.

Residential Delivery default $85. Houses and apartments are slower than warehouses.

Appointment Required default $45. The driver must book a time window instead of rolling up.

Limited Access default $65. Places like schools, farms, or military gates take extra time.

You can change each fee before you generate. Unchecked boxes add $0.

9. Analytics fields the customer never types as prices

9.1 Transit, holding, and class risk

Transit mean days is the typical number of days this lane takes. If you measured miles, the app can guess days as miles divided by 600, rounded up. 600 miles is about what one driver can legally drive in a day.

Transit standard deviation is how wobbly the lane is. A small number means 'usually the same.' A big number means 'sometimes late.'

Desired CSL is the chance you want the freight to arrive by the promised window, like 95 out of 100 times. Buffer days = Z-score for that chance times the wobbly number. That buffer is extra planning days, not extra money on the freight line.

Annual holding rate defaults to 20%. That is a simple way to say 'money tied up in goods costs about 20% a year.' Daily holding per pallet = commodity value x 0.20 / 365. Pipeline inventory cost = daily holding x days on the truck x pallet count. This shows the customer that slow freight is not free even if the invoice looks cheap.

Reclassification penalty is a warning dollar amount if the pallet is oversized (longer or wider than 48 inches, or taller than 60). The app may show a higher NMFC class. That is a risk talk, not an automatic add to the total unless you put it in the ledger yourself.

Buffer days and pipeline cost

buffer days = Z(desired CSL) x lane standard deviation

daily holding per pallet = commodity value per pallet x holding rate / 365

pipeline inventory = daily holding x mean transit days x pallet count

Tiny example: $5,000 goods per pallet, 20% holding, 3 days, 6 pallets. Daily holding = 5000 x 0.20 / 365 = about $2.74. Pipeline = 2.74 x 3 x 6 = about $49.32. That is the 'sitting on the truck' cost of the goods, not the freight bill.

10. Generate, print, and file name

10.1 Buttons and names

Click Generate Quote. The app checks that pallets are at least 1 and the total is greater than $0. If something is wrong, it stays on the form.

The printed page title, and the name Chrome offers when you Save as PDF, is LTL-Q plus the quote number. Example: LTL-Q4242. Click Print Quote. Do not rename it to something cute. The Q number is how we find it later.

The same number is used across modes. The letters in front tell you the mode. LTL-Q10 and FTL-Q10 are different quotes if both number 10 happened in different modes over time. The counter is shared, so usually the numbers just go 1, 2, 3 for the whole app.

Back to Builder returns you to the form. Load Previous Quote can bring this snapshot back.

11. Every output field and customer value

11.1 Letterhead and route

Company name, phone, email, website, DOT, and MC prove who we are. Rep name and email prove who they should call. Quote number is the ticket stub. Dates tell them how long the price is good (30 days on this mode).

ORIGIN and DESTINATION with city and ZIP answer 'where does it go?' Distance prints when miles were stored. Transit window prints as a range of business days so nobody treats a guess like a guaranteed appointment.

11.2 Guaranteed All-In Freight Ledger

This is the money table. Linehaul, fuel, each accessorial, then the total. Customers buy totals they can explain to their boss. Showing the split teaches them why a residential delivery costs more than a warehouse delivery.

Price per pallet lets them compare this quote to the last one even if pallet counts change.

Cost per pallet-mile (total / pallets / miles) is a fairness check. If this number is wild compared to similar lanes, you probably mistyped money or miles.

11.3 Advanced logistics analytics

NMFC class from density is a 'will the carrier rebill us?' warning. If class looks high, the freight is fluffy. Tell the customer to confirm dimensions.

Safety / buffer days help operations plan inventory. A customer who needs goods for a store opening cares more about this than a penny on linehaul.

CO2 estimate uses miles x tons x 0.162 kg per ton-mile. It is a footprint story, not a tax. Only show it if the customer asked about sustainability.

Pipeline inventory cost turns transit time into dollars of goods sitting still. That is how you sell a slightly faster option without only talking about the freight invoice.

12. What to say out loud

12.1 Simple pitch

You can say: 'This is one shared-truck shipment. You are buying space for these pallets, not the whole trailer. The total on the bottom is what you pay if nothing extra happens. Liftgate and house delivery are called out so there are no surprises. The day range is our planning window, not a guaranteed appointment unless we sell a guaranteed service later.'

13. Common mistakes

13.1 Fix these before you send

Using Tiered when they already have a count, or Single when they want a menu.

Forgetting Calculate Distance, then wondering why miles and pallet-mile cost are blank.

Typing per-pallet rate AND a huge linehaul, then being shocked at the total.

Leaving Include customer off when the PDF is going to that customer.

Loading a previous quote from memory instead of the picker, and mixing FTL numbers into LTL.

Definitions	
LTL	Less Than Truckload. Many customers share one trailer. You pay for your slice.
Pallet	A wooden (or plastic) platform that boxes sit on so a forklift can move them.
Linehaul	The main ride price from pickup to delivery, before extras.
FSC	Fuel surcharge. Extra money because diesel is not free.
Accessorial	Extra service money: liftgate, residential, appointment, limited access.
NMFC class	A freight 'difficulty' number from density and handling. Wrong class can change the invoice.
Density	Pounds per cubic foot. Heavy-small is denser than light-fluffy.
CSL	Cycle service level. How often you want to be on time, like 95%.
Pipeline inventory	The dollar cost of goods sitting on a truck instead of on a shelf.
LTL-Q	The print file prefix for both LTL single and LTL tiered quotes.

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